

Audit Preparation Companion

Example LLC

Calibration and test & measurement laboratory serving automotive and aerospace manufacturers from Greenville, South Carolina, USA, specializing in NIST-traceable calibration services.

Locale	en-US
Prepared for	Dana Whitfield
Companion to	Quality Management System Manual · Example LLC v1.0

This companion document supports the use of your Quality Management System Manual in preparation for ISO 9001:2015 certification audits. Each section is tailored to Example LLC's calibration and measurement operations, guiding your preparation around company-specific processes, roles, and evidence needs. Use this guide alongside active internal reviews to ensure that day-to-day practices and documentation are ready for scrutiny.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 4

Context of the Organization & Process Landscape

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ How does Example LLC ensure that calibration traceability to NIST is maintained for all customer jobs, including on-site calibrations?
- ☐ What are the primary risks identified for the calibration and test & measurement services, and how are these addressed in your current processes?
- ☐ Can you show how customer requirements, especially those specific to automotive and aerospace supply chains, are captured and built into your documented procedures?
- ☐ How are the support processes—such as reference standards management, supplier oversight, and staff training—integrated with calibration operations at your Greenville lab?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Signed and dated quality policy reflecting traceability and documentation commitments, accessible to employees and customers.
- ☐ Process flow maps or written descriptions outlining intake, calibration, documentation, reference management, and complaint handling (including roles of Theresa Nguyen, Marcus Bell, Kevin Park, and Dana Whitfield).
- ☐ Documented risk assessment or listing of major operational risks (e.g., certificate errors, late reference standard recalibration, inconsistent procedures), including mitigation actions.
- ☐ Records demonstrating how external customer requirements—especially for traceability (NIST), documentation, and turnaround—are incorporated into day-to-day procedures.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ The signed quality policy must be current (typically reviewed at least annually, or following significant changes in the organization).
- ☐ Process maps and risk assessments should reflect the current operational practices as "lived" over the past 2–3 months, not just as drafted documents.
- ☐ Evidence of process review and risk assessments should be updated at least annually and after any incidents requiring substantial process change.
- ☐ Retention periods for process- and risk-related records must match applicable US state and federal requirements, as well as any relevant customer or industry mandates.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Confirm that the signed quality policy is up to date and available to all staff and—if appropriate—customers.
- ☐ Map out all key processes (intake, assignment, calibration, certificate issue, complaint handling) with responsibilities for Theresa Nguyen, Marcus Bell, Kevin Park, and Dana Whitfield clearly documented.
- ☐ Review and update your list of major operational risks—ensure risk mitigations and controls are consistently documented and disseminated among staff.
- ☐ Prepare examples showing how demanding customer requirements (e.g., for traceability or accelerated turnaround) are incorporated in your documented procedures and daily work.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 5

Leadership & Responsibilities

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ How does Dana Whitfield demonstrate overall responsibility for the Quality Management System and communicate the importance of quality objectives to the Example LLC team?
- ☐ Can you describe how roles—including those of Marcus Bell (Lab Manager), Theresa Nguyen (Front Office), and Kevin Park (Reference Standards)—are defined and how accountability for quality is ensured?
- ☐ Describe the process for briefing staff regarding changes to procedures or corrective actions following management review at Example LLC. How do you ensure everyone is aware and trained?
- ☐ When a quality issue—such as a certificate error or late reference standard—arises, how is leadership involvement documented, and what steps lead to resolution?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Organizational chart or documented roles and responsibility matrix (including explicit responsibilities for Dana Whitfield, Marcus Bell, Theresa Nguyen, Kevin Park, and technicians).
- ☐ Records of staff communications (emails, meeting minutes, or briefing materials) regarding quality objectives, new/revised procedures, and corrective actions.
- ☐ Minutes, agendas, or attendance lists for management review and team meetings where quality, roles, and changes are discussed.
- ☐ Records of appointment and sign-offs showing authority and accountability for quality decisions (e.g., approvals given by Dana Whitfield).

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Roles and responsibilities documentation should reflect the current team and any recent changes, updated at least annually and after staff turnover.
- ☐ Management reviews must be formally documented at least once per year.
- ☐ Team briefings or training records for new or revised procedures should be available for all changes within the audit cycle.
- ☐ Retention of leadership, review, and notification records must follow all applicable US legal and customer contract requirements.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Review and update the roles and responsibilities matrix—ensure it matches the personnel currently in place.
- ☐ Compile management review agendas, minutes, and action item logs from recent years for auditor examination.
- ☐ Collect evidence of communications with staff about objectives, corrective actions, and QMS changes, including any email briefings and in-person meeting records.
- ☐ Ensure that records clearly show leadership decision points and delegated authorizations (e.g., when Marcus Bell acts on Dana Whitfield's behalf).

ISO 9001 · CHAPTERS 6–7

Support Processes, Document Control & Internal Audit

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ What is your process for monitoring the recalibration schedule of NIST-traceable reference standards, and how does Kevin Park document due dates and certificate renewals?

- ☐ Show how lab management software is used to manage document versions and ensure that only the current calibration procedures and certificate templates are used by technicians.
- ☐ Can you provide sample records from your last internal audit, including the areas audited, findings, and corrective actions taken?
- ☐ How does Example LLC ensure only trained technicians carry out calibrations, and that training records are kept up to date?
- ☐ What happens if a reference standard returns from calibration out-of-tolerance? How are potential impacts on past customer jobs addressed?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Digital log or tracking register showing all reference standards, recalibration due dates, certificates, and status, as maintained by Kevin Park.
- ☐ Sample calibration records and certificates demonstrating the use of current, approved document templates and clear version control.
- ☐ Internal audit schedule, executed audit reports (including findings, nonconformities, and follow-up actions), and evidence that all areas are covered over time.
- ☐ Training records and sign-offs for new staff, trainees, and changes to procedures (signed and dated confirmation that bench technicians, including the trainee, have been briefed).
- ☐ Corrective action logs and related communications from situations where an out-of-tolerance reference standard was found, detailing analysis and impacts on affected calibrations.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Reference standards must be recalibrated at intervals prescribed by their type and risk, with schedules and logs demonstrably up to date. Ongoing monitoring must show at least 3 months of activity prior to audit.
- ☐ Document control processes should be in active use for at least 2–3 months before certification, with clear date/version evidence across documents.
- ☐ Internal audits must be carried out at least annually, with a schedule that ensures every core and support process is covered over the audit cycle before Stage 2.
- ☐ Training and competence records should be updated whenever new staff join, when roles change, or when new documentation/procedures are introduced.
- ☐ Retention of audit, document control, and training records must meet the most stringent of customer, industry, or local US regulatory requirements.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Review and, if necessary, update the digital reference standard log; confirm calibration intervals, due dates, and statuses reflect real shop floor practice.

- ☐ Collect sample calibration records and ensure each reflects a unique identifier, correct use of the latest template, and version tracking within the lab management system.
- ☐ Assemble at least one full internal audit report (including checklists, findings, actions, and evidence of follow-up) performed and closed prior to Stage 2.
- ☐ Update and make available technician training records and sign-offs; include documentation of briefings following any procedural changes or corrective actions.
- ☐ Gather evidence relating to any recent out-of-tolerance findings on reference standards and related impact analyses and actions.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTERS 8–10

Operation, KPI Tracking, Management Review & Improvement

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ You target reducing the certificate correction rate to 2 or fewer per year. Show how this is measured and reported each month, and explain who acts when the rate exceeds target.
- ☐ Describe how you track on-time delivery rate for calibration jobs and what escalation is triggered if turnaround times slip below your 95% target.
- ☐ Can you provide the log verifying that no reference standards were overdue for recalibration, and explain what happens if a deadline is missed?
- ☐ Show the last two management review reports and how deviations from objectives led to corrective actions, changes in procedures, or additional training.
- ☐ How does Example LLC ensure every complaint, certificate correction, or process improvement suggestion is logged, investigated, and brought to closure with verification of effectiveness?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ KPI tracking records for certificate corrections and on-time delivery, including monthly tabulations and trend charts if available.
- ☐ Action logs, meeting minutes, or email evidence showing response and escalation steps taken when objectives or targets are missed (especially by Marcus Bell or Dana Whitfield).
- ☐ Reference standard recalibration log showing status for each standard over at least the last 3 months, plus corrective action details if any were overdue.
- ☐ Management review reports with lists of open and closed actions, assigned owners, and outcome verification for at least the past two cycles.
- ☐ Complaint log, root cause analysis records, and corrective action/closure evidence for incidents relating to certificate errors, late jobs, or customer concerns.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ KPI data should cover a minimum of 3 months prior to Stage 2 and be updated at least monthly, with trends visible over time.
- ☐ Complaints and certificate corrections must be logged immediately as received and followed up through defined corrective action processes, with no action closed unless effectiveness is verified.
- ☐ Management reviews documenting progress against objectives should be done at least annually, and immediately following serious process deviations.
- ☐ Retain KPI, corrective action, and management review records in accordance with all applicable US legal/regulatory requirements and critical customer contracts.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Start collecting objective data for certificate correction rate, on-time delivery, and no-overdue reference standards on a rolling monthly basis.
- ☐ Establish routine review of KPIs during monthly meetings, documenting any trends or deviations and recorded action steps.
- ☐ Compile at least two management review reports before your Stage 2 audit, ensuring follow-up actions are tracked to closure.
- ☐ Maintain an up-to-date complaint and corrective action log, including root cause analysis and closure verification for all issues that arise prior to audit.
- ☐ Review and ensure each improvement, corrective, or preventive action includes clear evidence of effectiveness review before closure.